

Sample Texas Employee Handbook

Generic HR policies for a Texas-based employer

Effective date: Sample - update before use

Important demo notice: This is a generic sample document for a Texas-based HR demo. It is not legal advice, does not create an employment contract, and should be reviewed by qualified HR/legal counsel before use by a real employer.

1. Employment Relationship

- Employment is at-will unless a written contract signed by an authorized company officer says otherwise. Either the employee or company may end employment at any time, with or without cause or advance notice, subject to applicable law.
- This handbook is a guide to policies and expectations, not a contract or guarantee of employment.
- The company may update, interpret, suspend, or end policies at any time, consistent with applicable law.

2. Equal Employment Opportunity

- The company provides equal employment opportunities and prohibits discrimination, harassment, and retaliation based on protected characteristics under federal, state, or local law.
- Employment decisions should be based on qualifications, performance, business needs, and lawful job-related criteria.

3. Anti-Harassment and Complaint Reporting

- Harassment, bullying, intimidation, or retaliation is prohibited whether it occurs in person, online, through work systems, or at company events.
- Employees should report concerns to HR, a manager, or another designated leader. Reports will be reviewed promptly and as confidentially as practical.
- Retaliation against an employee who raises a good-faith concern or participates in an investigation is prohibited.

4. Work Hours, Timekeeping, and Overtime

- Non-exempt employees must accurately record all hours worked, including remote work and time spent responding to work messages after hours.
- Non-exempt employees must receive approval before working overtime. Unauthorized overtime may lead to discipline, but all hours actually worked must still be reported and paid.
- Covered non-exempt employees are paid overtime at one and one-half times the regular rate for hours worked over 40 in a workweek, unless an exemption applies.

5. Paydays and Payroll Corrections

- Employees are paid on the company's published pay schedule. If an employee believes a paycheck is incorrect, they should notify Payroll or HR promptly.
- The company will review reported payroll issues and make corrections when appropriate.

6. Attendance and Punctuality

- Employees are expected to report to work as scheduled, be ready to work at the start of their shift, and notify their manager as soon as possible if they will be late or absent.
- Excessive absenteeism, tardiness, or job abandonment may result in corrective action, subject to applicable leave laws.

7. Confidentiality and Data Protection

- Employees must protect confidential company, customer, employee, and vendor information.
- Company systems should be used responsibly. Passwords, sensitive files, and customer data must not be shared without authorization.

8. Workplace Safety

- Employees should follow safety rules, report unsafe conditions, and promptly report work-related injuries or incidents to a supervisor or HR.
- The company may require job-specific safety training, equipment, or reporting procedures.

9. Standards of Conduct

- Employees are expected to act professionally, follow policies, treat others respectfully, and avoid conflicts of interest.
- Examples of conduct that may lead to corrective action include dishonesty, harassment, theft, unsafe behavior, misuse of company systems, falsifying time records, and insubordination.

10. Acknowledgment

I acknowledge that I received this sample handbook and understand that it is not a contract. I understand that policies may change and that employment is at-will unless otherwise required by law or a written agreement.

Employee Name: _____ Signature: _____ Date: _____

Reference Notes

- Texas Workforce Commission (TWC), Texas Payday Law and Texas Guidebook for Employers: final pay, fringe benefits, and accrued leave payout guidance.
- U.S. Department of Labor, Wage and Hour Division: Fair Labor Standards Act overtime rules for non-exempt employees.

These references are summarized for demo accuracy. Replace with company-specific legal review before real implementation.